

Nevada Small Business Bookkeeping Checklist

Everything a Nevada small business owner needs to set up, maintain, and stay compliant with their books — organized into monthly, quarterly, and annual tasks with Nevada-specific compliance notes.

Updated
2026

Nevada &
California

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This checklist was prepared by **Heather Potvin, Certified Public Bookkeeper (CPB)** and founder of Hharpp Business Services. Use it to audit your current bookkeeping practices, onboard a new bookkeeper, or confirm you're meeting Nevada's specific compliance requirements. Items marked **NV** are Nevada-specific obligations. Items marked **CONST** apply to construction and contracting businesses.

Monthly bookkeeping tasks

- ☐ Reconcile all bank accounts to your accounting software
Every account, every month — no exceptions. Unreconciled accounts accumulate errors that compound.
- ☐ Reconcile all credit card accounts
Match every transaction to a receipt or expense record before closing the month.
- ☐ Categorize and review all transactions
Correct categorization affects your P&L accuracy and your tax deductions.
- ☐ Review accounts receivable — follow up on anything over 30 days outstanding
Cash flow starts with collecting what you're owed.
- ☐ Review accounts payable — confirm all bills are recorded and scheduled
- ☐ Generate and review Profit & Loss statement
Know your actual net income before the month is 30 days old.
- ☐ Review balance sheet for anomalies
Unexplained changes in assets or liabilities often indicate data entry errors or missing transactions.
- ☐ Run payroll and confirm all deposits made on time
Federal payroll tax deposits are due within 1–3 business days of payroll depending on your deposit schedule.
- ☐ Update job costing records for active projects **CONST**
Every labor hour, material invoice, and subcontractor payment should be assigned to a job before month-end.
- ☐ Review WIP (Work in Progress) report **CONST**
Know which jobs are over/under billed against completion percentage.

Quarterly compliance tasks

- ☐ **File federal Form 941 (payroll taxes)**
Due last day of month following quarter end: April 30, July 31, Oct 31, Jan 31.
- ☐ **File Nevada Modified Business Tax (MBT) return** **NV**
Quarterly return due by last day of month following quarter. Rate: 1.378% of wages above threshold.
- ☐ **File Nevada Unemployment Insurance (UI) quarterly report** **NV**
File with NV DETR. Due same schedule as MBT. Failure to file triggers penalties + interest.
- ☐ **File Nevada Sales & Use Tax return** **NV**
2026 update: Nevada moved deadline to the 20th of the following month — not month-end.
- ☐ **Review estimated tax payments (federal)**
Due: April 15, June 15, Sept 15, Jan 15. Underpayment triggers penalty.
- ☐ **Review cash flow forecast for next 90 days**
Identify shortfalls before they become emergencies.

NEVADA 2026 COMPLIANCE UPDATE

Nevada changed its sales tax filing deadline from the last day of the month to the **20th of the following month**, effective January 2026. If your accounting system or calendar still shows the old deadline, update it now to avoid late penalties. The Henderson/Las Vegas area combined sales tax rate is **8.38%**.

Annual tasks & year-end close

- ☐ **Reconcile all 12 months — confirm no month was skipped**
Your CPA or tax preparer will ask for this. Missing months = expensive catch-up billing.
- ☐ **Send W-2s to all employees by January 31**
- ☐ **Send 1099-NEC forms to all contractors paid \$600+ by January 31**
Collect W-9s from contractors before you pay them — not after. Do not wait until January.
- ☐ **File Nevada Commerce Tax return (if gross revenue exceeded \$4M)** **NV**
Due August 14. Rates vary by industry code (0.051%–0.331%). Most small businesses fall below threshold.
- ☐ **Review fixed asset schedule — add new assets, remove disposed assets**
Depreciation deductions require an accurate asset list. Construction companies: include equipment.
- ☐ **Close all books for the prior year — lock accounting period**
Prevent accidental entries into the closed year after your CPA files taxes.
- ☐ **Deliver organized books to your CPA by February 28 at the latest**
Late delivery = extension filing + higher CPA fees.
- ☐ **Review profit-sharing, retirement, and benefits contributions for year**
- ☐ **Finalize job profitability reports for all completed projects** **CONST**
Compare estimated vs. actual cost per job. Use this data to improve estimates in the next year.

QuickBooks health check

- ☐ **Run QuickBooks Verify Data utility — fix any errors found**

Tools > Verify Data in Desktop. In QBO, run a transaction report and look for uncategorized items.

- ☐ Confirm chart of accounts matches your business structure
Construction businesses need job cost accounts. Service businesses need project or client tracking accounts.
- ☐ Review user access — remove access for departed employees or contractors
- ☐ Back up your QuickBooks file (Desktop) or confirm cloud sync (Online)
- ☐ Update payroll tax tables (QuickBooks Desktop)
Outdated tax tables cause incorrect withholding calculations.

IS YOUR CURRENT BOOKKEEPER DOING ALL OF THIS?

If you completed this checklist and found gaps — missing reconciliations, unfiled Nevada returns, or a QuickBooks file that hasn't been touched in months — **Hharpp offers a complimentary Customer Value Analysis** to assess exactly where your books stand and what it would take to fix it. No obligation. No pressure. Just an honest assessment from a Certified Public Bookkeeper with 16 years of experience.

Hharpp Business Services

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